

which, in our opinion, is completely worth it owing to the vast number of customisation options and features it offers. Here are some tips and tricks to supercharge your experience when using the Nova Launcher Free and Prime version.

SWIPE ACTIONS FOR FOLDERS AND APPS

If you prefer a minimalist and uncluttered look on your homescreen, you can hide icons within a folder in plain sight and have only one icon of your choosing appear as the representative one. So, if you have a social media apps folder, you can choose to have the Instagram icon as the representative one while all other social media apps' icons are hidden. When the icon is pressed, the corresponding app, in this case – Instagram, will open up. To access all the apps within the folder, you need to simply swipe up on the icon and the folder will be opened up, showing all the apps within.

To set up this feature, first make a folder like you usually do on Android by dragging apps into a folder. Next, long-press the folder and click on 'Edit'. Now, toggle on the 'Swipe to open' option in the window that opens up. After you've toggled it on, click on the 'Tap Action' option and from the drop-down window, select the 'First item in the folder'. If you want to choose another icon as your main icon, move that app to the first spot in the folder.

You can also use swipe actions on particular app icons to make swiping up open another related app or perform a task. So, your Camera icon can open up



'Swipe to open' gesture for hidden folders

the Gallery when you swipe up or the Calendar app can add a reminder upon swiping up. To do this, long press an icon and select 'Edit'. Press the 'Swipe Action' option and select any action or app of your choosing. Note that these features are only available in the Prime variant.

CUSTOMISE APP ICONS

Nova Launcher doesn't only allow users to easily change icon packs but also lets users change icons of specific apps. To do this, press and hold the desired app's icon, and then tap on the 'Edit' button. Now, just tap on the app's icon in the window that opens up. Nova will present you with a bunch of built in icons, icons from icon packs, or the ability to choose a custom image from the Gallery. Nova also comes with a feature called Adaptive Icons that can be utilised to customise a particular icon's shape, size, and text, all without having access to the Prime Version of the app.

To access Adaptive icons, head over to Nova Settings and go to 'Look & Feel'. Now,

tap on 'Icon Style'. Here, you will find the Adaptive Icon options. You can choose from six different icon shapes including System, Square, Round and others. You can also tick 'Reshape Legacy Icons' to ensure all icons have a uniform shape. Additionally, you can also create a custom icon shape from the Adaptive Icons settings, if none of the presets suit the look you're going for.

To customise the text under icons, or remove it completely, head to the App Drawer in Nova Settings and then go to 'Icon Layout'. From here, you can tweak the font, colour and size of the text. You can even add shadows to the text labels or choose to remove the text entirely. We encourage you to play around with these options extensively to figure out what's the best move for your desired look.

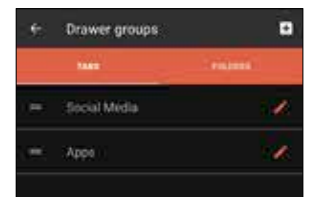
MAKE FOLDERS TRANSPARENT

Again, for a more minimalist and streamlined style for your Android home screen, folders with coloured or white backgrounds can often dilute the overall effect and appear intrusive.

So, you can choose to make folder backgrounds transparent with Nova Launcher. To do this, head over to Nova Settings and then go to Folders > Window Style. Now, slide the Transparency Bar here to the desired percentage, we suggest a 100 percent transparency since it looks the most classy. Now, when you open up a folder on the homescreen, the background will be completely transparent and therefore, less obtrusive.

CREATE TABS IN APP DRAWER

The Android app drawer is infamous for being a notorious mess at times and finding an app in your app drawer can sometimes be a struggle, especially if you horde 40-50 apps on your smartphone. In order to employ a more discrete and streamlined arrangement, you can create tabs in your app drawer which you can scroll through. To create tabs in the app drawer (Prime version only), fire up Nova Settings > App drawer. Scroll all the way to the bottom and select 'Drawer groups'.



To arrange your app drawer into groups, you can use the Tab feature in Nova

Now, you can add additional tabs by pressing the plus sign in the top-right corner. You can name these tabs by category such as Streaming, Social Media, Music, Work, etc and fill them up with related apps. Once you've set up your tabs, you can choose if you